Annual Report: Global Renewable Energy Trends (2026)

Published by: International Institute for Sustainable Technology (IIST)
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Executive Summary

This annual report analyzes the accelerating transition toward zero-carbon electricity generation. In 2026, renewable energy capacity expanded by a record 510 gigawatts (GW) globally, representing a 48% increase compared to 2024 levels, led primarily by solar photovoltaic (PV).

Key Findings

- Solar PV accounted for 72% of total new renewable energy additions worldwide.
- Levelized Cost of Energy (LCOE) for utility-scale solar dropped to $0.028 per kWh.
- Offshore wind installations in Northern Europe and East Asia grew by 24.5 GW.
- Battery Energy Storage Systems (BESS) installed capacity surpassed 180 GWh worldwide.

Regional Breakdown

Asia-Pacific (APAC)

- APAC maintained global leadership, accounting for 58% of new solar installations.
- Large-scale investments in green hydrogen production hubs expanded in Australia and India.

North America & Europe

- Grid modernization and interconnection queue reforms drove faster transmission approvals.
- Corporate Power Purchase Agreements (PPAs) reached an all-time high of $34 Billion.

Strategic Policy Recommendations

- Expand long-duration energy storage (LDES) incentives for multi-day grid stability.
- Modernize cross-border high-voltage direct current (HVDC) transmission lines.